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# Lidocaine Infusion Therapy: Patient Information Leaflet

This leaflet provides essential information about intravenous (IV) lidocaine infusion therapy for pain management. Your pain specialist will discuss a specific treatment plan with you.

## What is Lidocaine Infusion?

Lidocaine is a local anesthetic medication. When administered intravenously via an automated pump through a small tube (cannula) in your arm or hand, it may help manage certain chronic pain conditions.

Note: This use is "off-label" (not officially licensed for chronic pain), but it is widely accepted in pain management practice.

## Who Might Benefit?

This therapy may be considered if you have:

- ✓ Chronic neuropathic pain (nerve-related pain)
- ✓ Complex regional pain syndrome (CRPS)
- ✓ Persistent headaches (e.g., cluster headaches)
- ✓ Pain unresponsive to standard treatments (e.g., oral medications, physical therapy).

Pain relief and duration vary among individuals, with 20-60% of patients experiencing a 11-60% reduction in pain.

## Before Your Infusion

### Preparation is crucial for safety:

**Fasting:** Do not eat for 6 hours before treatment. Clear fluids (water/black coffee) are allowed until 2 hours beforehand.

**Medications:** Continue regular medicines unless your doctor advises otherwise. Bring a full medication list.

**Health Disclosure:** Inform your team if you have:

- Heart, liver, or kidney disease
- History of seizures, irregular heartbeat, or abnormal ECG
- Previous reactions to local anesthetics
- Pregnancy (or suspected pregnancy) – not recommended

## During the Infusion

**Duration:** 1–2 hours in a clinic/hospital setting.

**Monitoring:** Continuous heart rate, blood pressure, and oxygen level checks are done.

**What to Expect:** You may feel drowsy, dizzy, or notice a metallic taste – report these immediately.

**Aftercare:** Observation for 30–60 minutes post-infusion to monitor for side effects.

## Potential Side Effects

### Common (usually mild/subside quickly):

- Drowsiness, dizziness, anxiety and headache
- Numbness/tingling around the mouth
- Metallic taste, blurred vision, or ringing in ears.

### Serious (rare, require urgent attention):

- Irregular heartbeat, chest pain, or fainting
- Severe allergic reaction (rash, swelling, breathing difficulty)
- Seizures, tremors, or confusion.

***Seek immediate help if you experience bluish lips/skin, trouble breathing, or rapid heartbeat after leaving the clinic – report to your local Emergency Department***

## After the Infusion

- Do NOT drive or operate machinery for 24 hours .
- Resume normal activities gradually, unless advised otherwise .
- Pain relief timing: Benefits may take weeks to months to appear. You will not know results on the day of treatment.
- Follow-up: A phone or clinic appointment will be scheduled at an appropriate interval to assess effectiveness. Repeat infusions may be offered if helpful.

## Important Warnings

- Not a cure: This therapy aims to 'reduce' pain, not eliminate it.
- Contraindications: Unsuitable if you have severe heart block, uncontrolled epilepsy, or liver failure.
- Drug interactions: Disclose all medications (e.g., beta-blockers, antiarrhythmics) to avoid risks.

## Questions? Contact Your Care Team

Before/after infusion:

 782-377-7813

 [Info@redsandspm.com](mailto:Info@redsandspm.com)

In an emergency

→ Call 911, or visit your local emergency department